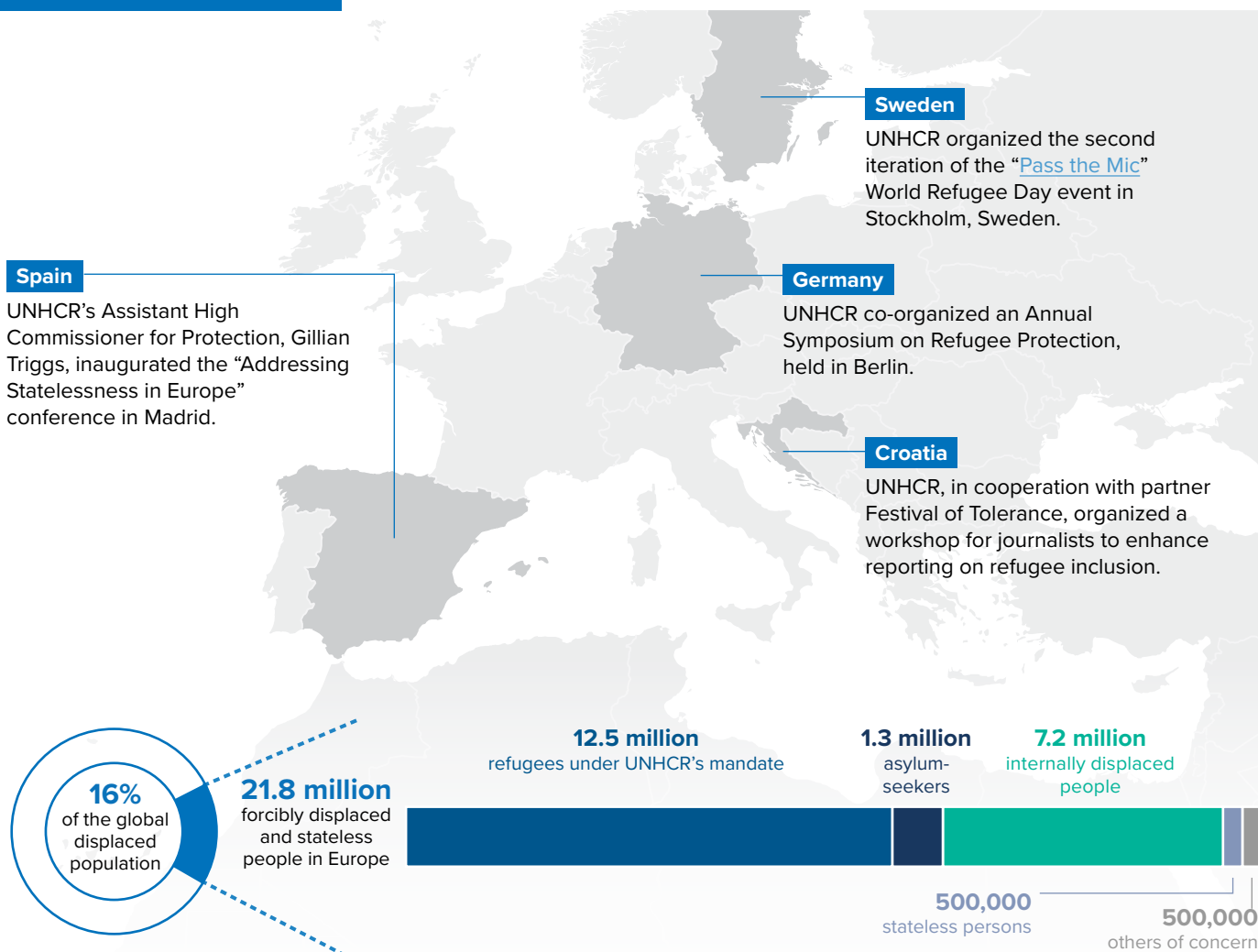


EUROPE AT A GLANCE



Source: UNHCR [data finder platform](#) and mid-year statistics as of 30 June 2022.

References to Kosovo shall be understood to be in the context of Security Council Resolution 1244 (1999). The boundaries and names shown, and the designations used on this map do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by the United Nations.

ARRIVALS AND DISPLACED POPULATIONS: KEY FIGURES AND TRENDS IN EUROPE

UKRAINE SITUATION

5,912,600 individual refugees from Ukraine were recorded across Europe as of end June 2023 and over 5 million Ukrainian refugees had registered for temporary protection or similar national protection schemes in Europe¹. An estimated 4.8 million people were displaced inside Ukraine in May².

MEDITERRANEAN AND NORTHWEST AFRICAN MARITIME ROUTES

22,200 refugees and migrants arrived in Europe via the three Mediterranean and Northwest African maritime routes in June 2023, a 91 per cent increase compared to the previous month. Top arrivals by country of origin include: Tunisia, Egypt, Bangladesh, Syrian Arab Republic and Côte d'Ivoire. As of 30 June, 2,148 people have been reported dead or missing on the three Mediterranean and the Northwest African maritime routes.

SOUTH EASTERN EUROPE

1,800 persons have arrived in or transited through the subregion in June 2023, 29 per cent less than the previous month and 42 per cent less than in June 2022.

TÜRKIYE

Türkiye hosts the world's largest refugee population with over **3.6 million** Syrians under temporary protection and some 319,000 refugees and asylum-seekers from other countries under international protection.

¹ [Operational Date Portal: Ukraine Refugee Situation](#)

² [IOM Displacement Tracking Matrix](#) 3 April 2023

UKRAINE SITUATION

- Approximately 2,200 people were evacuated following the Kakhovka dam breach on 6 June, with the number of displaced people rising to nearly 4,000 in Khersonska and Mykolaivska oblasts in the weeks following the dam's collapse. The incident impacted tens of thousands of people who were already without access to piped water in southern and eastern Ukraine. The reservoir — which normally provides drinking water for at least 700,000 people — lost 70 per cent of its capacity according to Ukrainian authorities. In Dnipropetrovaska oblast, large urban areas were completely cut off from centralized water supply, and other areas had limited access.
- The UN and humanitarian organizations quickly mobilized to provide urgent assistance to those affected including providing drinking water, legal counselling and psychosocial support. UNHCR also pre-positioned emergency supplies and delivered aid to affected communities, while providing accommodation support. Between 9 - 17 June, UNHCR participated in 12 interagency convoys that delivered aid to affected settlements in Dnipropetrovaska and Khersonska oblasts, during which UNHCR provided over 31,000 items including jerry cans, solar lamps, sleeping bags, mattresses, and tarpaulins to displaced people in need. UNHCR also pre-positioned 140,000 non-food items (NFIs) across the country to respond to the growing needs. Over 7,300 people affected by the dam breach registered for UNHCR cash assistance.



734,923

people inside Ukraine were reached with protection services by UNHCR and partners in 2023



240,500

refugees from Ukraine were reached with protection services by UNHCR and partners (inclusion support, legal support, social protection, accommodation) in host countries in 2023

ASYLUM AND PROTECTION

- **France:** On 8 June, UNHCR [organized a seminar](#) on migration and asylum practices for Ukrainian and EU lawyers in Strasbourg. The seminar was made possible through collaboration with the Council of Europe's HELP (Human Rights Education for Legal Professionals) project, the European Commission, and the Slovak Bar Association. The focus of the seminar was on the implementation of the EU Temporary Protection Directive, UNHCR's research on displacement patterns and protection needs of refugees from Ukraine. The event brought together 45 lawyers specializing in migration law, with more than 80 participants joining online.



Hundreds of refugees and migrants feared dead and missing in worst sea tragedy off Greece in recent years. UNHCR and IOM call for coordinated action and safe pathways.

UNHCR was deeply shocked and saddened at the loss of life near Pylos in southern Greece, after a boat sank on 14 June, reportedly carrying hundreds of people. Initial information indicated that the boat had departed from Libya and was reportedly in distress since 13 June. "Each life lost is a tragedy", said Maria Clara Martin, UNHCR Representative in Greece. "We are profoundly saddened by the heart-breaking loss of so many lives. Our thoughts are with the survivors and with the relatives of those who have died. Such deaths can be avoided by creating more safe pathways for people forced to flee conflict and persecution. Nobody should have to resort to life-endangering journeys when fleeing for their lives."

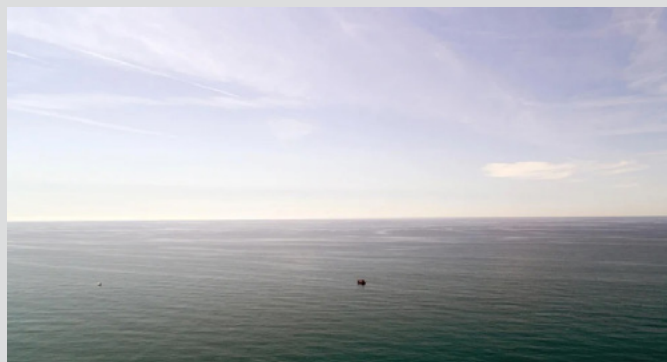


Photo: © UNHCR/Markel Redondo

- **Germany:** On 26 – 27 June, in collaboration with multiple stakeholders in the civil society, UNHCR co-organized the [Annual Symposium on Refugee Protection](#) in Berlin. The event gathered some 300 participants from various fields involved in refugee protection. The State Secretary at the Ministry of Interior, Bernd Krösner, opened the symposium and provided information on latest developments in the context of the Common European Asylum System (CEAS) reform. Civil society actors expressed concern about the reform, noting further steps were needed to address the primary obstacles of the CEAS to improve fundamental rights. The event included a panel discussion with members of the European Parliament, who shared further views on the reform process.

INCLUSION

- **Croatia:** On 15 June, a workshop for journalists took place on 15 June in Zagreb. The aim of the workshop, organized by UNHCR in cooperation with partner Festival of Tolerance, was to enhance reporting on refugee inclusion. The workshop featured various speakers, including a refugee law student, a BBC correspondent, and prominent Croatian journalists covering refugee-related issues. The discussions focused on increasing the visibility for inclusion stories in the media and addressing ethical dilemmas and professional standards when reporting on refugees. Around 15 media outlets including public broadcasters and major newspapers were represented at the conference.
- **Serbia:** On 1 June, UNHCR organized the first in a series of conferences on “The Role of the Private Sector in Refugee Integration” in Belgrade. The conference marked the initial phase of the newly established network between UNHCR and IKEA. The conference addressed the pressing needs of refugees and asylum-seekers, including access to dignified employment and healthcare. Over 30 representatives from industries such as retail, consulting, and catering attended the event. Eight companies and business associations joined the network, including the Chamber of Commerce representing 130 companies. The event received wide media coverage and included the presence of Serbia’s Deputy Commissioner for Refugees and Migration, the National Employment Service, and the Ambassador of Switzerland, who presented good practices from the Swiss context.



Greek and Refugee Chefs unite: Cooking #WithRefugees Festival returns to Athens for World Refugee Day

9 June 2023 - Through the universal language of food, this year’s edition of the #WithRefugees festival seeks to shine a spotlight on the skills and talents of refugees to show that integration is the most impactful way to help them restart their lives and actively contribute to their host communities. Greek and refugee [chefs teamed up](#) in four restaurants between 18 - 22 June to serve favourite dishes and fuse cuisines from Afghanistan, Cameroon, Syria and Ukraine during a special festival organized by UNHCR and partners.

Photo: Ilektra Rigkou (left) and Helen Saradis (right), both head chefs of Lost Athens Restaurant in Pangrati, Greece, take part in a cooking event with Roya Saifi, a refugee from Afghanistan, (middle) for the Cooking with Refugees Festival
© UNHCR/Achilleas Zavallis



STATELESSNESS

- **Armenia:** UNHCR organized a focus-group discussion with stateless individuals in Yerevan on 20 June as part of a series of discussions. The purpose was to collect data on challenges they face in obtaining citizenship, to develop recommendations for advocacy and programming, and design tailored assistance programs. Additionally, on 12 - 14 June UNHCR met with community representatives from eight provinces currently hosting stateless individuals (Gegharkunik, Kotayk, Shirak, Tavush). The meetings aimed to raise awareness about the main causes of statelessness, and reinforce collaboration between UNHCR and communities.
- **Spain:** On 9 June, UNHCR's Assistant High Commissioner for Protection, Gillian Triggs, inaugurated the "[Addressing Statelessness in Europe](#)" conference in Madrid, organized by the European Network on Statelessness (ENS), along with Fundación Cepaim and the Universidad Complutense of Madrid. The conference aimed to raise awareness on statelessness in Europe and drive policy changes to address the needs of stateless individuals ahead of the upcoming Spanish Presidency of the Council of the European Union starting in July and the Global Refugee Forum (GRF) in December 2023. The Assistant High Commissioner for Protection addressed ways to implement pledges made during a [High-Level Segment](#) at the first Global Refugee Forum (GRF) in 2019 to prevent and resolve statelessness in Europe. Discussions involved various stakeholders to find a path forward.

WORLD REFUGEE DAY

- **Austria:** On 12 April, UNHCR took part in the "Refugees at Austrian Universities: Invisible Talents?" conference organized by the Vienna University of Economics and Business Administration and the [Austrian Exchange Service](#) (ÖAD). The event showcased best practices and achievements in supporting refugee university students, highlighting challenges and exploring avenues for improving access. UNHCR introduced the [15by30 Roadmap](#), the [DAFI scholarship program](#), and the UNISTAR project, and referred to the [online toolkit](#) for university staff based on UNHCR best practices, and a blended course offered by the UNISTAR project.
- **Sweden:** On 27 April, UNHCR informed participants about a pilot education pathway program in Sweden at the Include Network's annual conference, comprised of [33 national academic institutions](#). UNHCR highlighted its [mapping report on Complementary Education Pathways in Nordic and Baltic countries](#) to serve as a future model. Include Network aims to increase participation and recruitment within higher education.

EUROPE MEDIA HIGHLIGHTS

PRESS RELEASES, STATEMENTS

News Comment [29 JUN]: UNHCR welcomes UK Court of Appeal judgment on transfer of asylum-seekers from the UK to Rwanda

Press Release [28 JUN]: Finland wins second UNITY EURO CUP highlighting inclusionary power of sport

News Comment [28 JUN]: News Comment by UNHCR's EU Representative on launch of Spanish Presidency of the European Union

Press Release [27 JUN]: UNHCR concerned with new legislation in Latvia

Press Release [16 JUN]: UNHCR and

IOM call for decisive action following Mediterranean tragedy

Press Release [14 JUN]: Fears for hundreds of dead and missing refugees and migrants in the worst maritime tragedy in Greece in recent years

Press Release [9 JUN]: European statelessness conference pushes for concrete action and commitments to resolve statelessness in Europe

TOP NEWS STORIES

BBC [29 JUN] Rwanda: Court of Appeal decision raises difficult questions

Daily Mail [23 JUN] Around 40 missing in Italy migrant boat shipwreck: UN

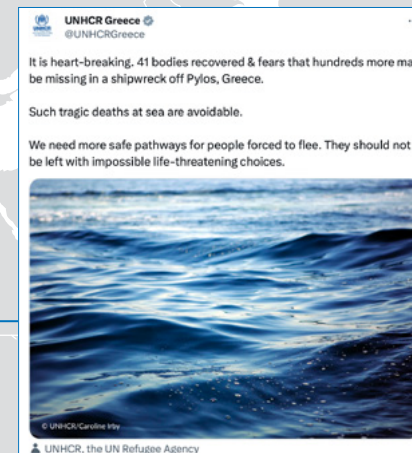
Associated Press [19 JUN]: Over 40 Companies Commit to Provide Jobs & Training to More Than 250,000 Ukrainian and Other Refugees at Tent European Business Summit

Washington Post [15 JUN]: Greek and E.U. policies under scrutiny after devastating shipwreck

CNN [14 JUN]: At least 78 people drown after migrant boat sinks off Greek coast

EUROPE MEDIA HIGHLIGHTS

COUNTRY OFFICE TWITTER HIGHLIGHTS



LEADERSHIP ACCOUNT TWEETS

Filippo Grandi, UN High Commissioner for Refugees:
The second Unity Euro Cup organized by UEFA and UNHCR in Frankfurt has been a powerful moment to celebrate refugee inclusion, achievement and hope. [28 JUN]

Gonzalo Vargas Llosa, UNHCR Representative for EU Affairs: Thank you European Parliament for shining the light on the situation of displaced women and girls in Africa, Asia and the Americas. [28 JUN]

Chiara Cardoletti, UNHCR Representative to Italy, the Holy See and San Marino:
Shipwreck off Lampedusa : 40 people missing, including at least 1 infant. It is unacceptable to continue counting the dead at the gates of Europe. [23 JUN]

Christoph Pinter, Head of UNHCR Austria Office:
This judgment by the Court of Justice of the European Union (CJEU) once again makes it clear why “Operation Fox” (police from Austria support for Hungarian police) is highly questionable. Refugees cannot apply for asylum in Hungary. [22 JUN]

Francesca Bonelli, UNHCR Representative to Moldova:
Very happy to announce our new High-Profile supporter in Moldova, the talented soprano Valentina Nafornița. [8 JUN]

STORY SPOTLIGHT

Football for Refugees

On 26 June, the second iteration of the Unity Euro Cup once again lived up to its promise of inclusion and empowerment. During the tournament, 16 teams of both male and female refugees and local players from participating European nations met in Frankfurt, Germany.

The UN High Commissioner for Refugees, Filippo Grandi, discussed the important role which football can play in helping refugees adapt to their new lives and communities. "Sport can be an important tool to respond to the problems of refugees in a series of ways. Often refugees have suffered major trauma affecting their mental health. Football is about healthy competition for people who are fleeing unhealthy conflicts. Sports and football are also about motivation, very often for people who are facing despair. Sport is inclusive. We often say that one of the best ways to protect refugees is to include them in society. Sport is a powerful instrument of inclusion and integration."

For more stories and highlights, [subscribe to our mailing list](#).



A player from the Spanish team aims for the Maltese goal at the UNITY EURO CUP in Frankfurt.
© UNHCR/Gordon Welters

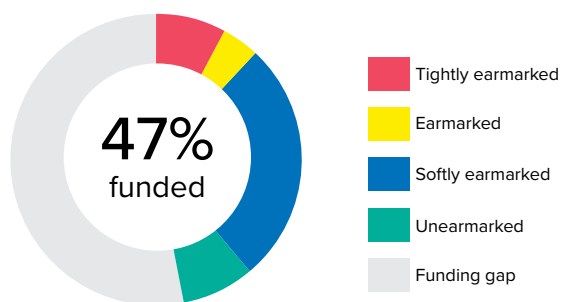
FINANCIAL INFORMATION

Requested for UNHCR's activities in Europe in 2023:

USD 1.694 billion*

Total contributed as of 27 June:

USD 797.03 million



*This amount includes financial requirements for the Ukraine situation.

WHERE TO FIND

For more information, reports and other resources:

- [UNHCR Europe webpage](#)
- [UNHCR Europe region monthly updates](#)
- [UNHCR Europe country operations fact sheets](#)
- [Europe pages of UNHCR's Global Focus webpage](#)
- [UNHCR Ukraine Emergency webpage](#)

Operational data portals:

- [Ukraine Refugee Situation](#)
- [Mediterranean Situation](#)

UNHCR is grateful for the support from our top government donors of unearmarked, softly earmarked and earmarked funding:

Belgium | Canada | Denmark | European Union | Faroe Islands | France | Germany | Iceland | Ireland | Italy | Japan | Kuwait | Netherlands | Norway | Qatar | Sweden | Switzerland | Republic of Korea | United Kingdom | United States of America

We are also grateful for the generous contributions from private individuals and the private sector.